

Mr. Charles Bracken
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The following is a faithful transcription of a carbon copy of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

The following might be a practical example with just a few details. It happened a few years ago when on a certain morning there was quite a crowd waiting here in the Monastery office, and an old-looking couple slowly rose from their seats and approaching the desk, asked in German, if they could speak to me personally. As we started into another room, I smelled a cancer, though I was not certain what it was till the old lady told me that her husband had cancer and could not work any more. She was the spokesman, and made no secret of it whatever. After a little I asked if they went to the holy Sacraments regularly. "My husband is not a Catholic," she answered. "Then, Mr. N.," I said, "You do something in your own honest way to please the God God." "What could I do to please Him? I was raised a Lutheran but for twenty years I have practiced no religion." "It's a poor way to be, man;" I answered, "and especially if you take it as I define Religion. THE SCIENCE OF OUR RELATIONSHIP WITH GOD AND OUR NEIGHBOR - I might say - OF OUR DEPENDENCE ON GOD AND OUR NEIGHBOR. To practice no religion is making a secondary matter of the primary purpose of our creation as rational beings, viz., TO KNOW GOD; that we may love Him and serve Him and be happy with Him. Now I'll tell you what you can do to please God. Just start and be earnest about saving your soul." "After all" I added, if you are a Lutheran, you believe in Jesus Christ. I believe in Him as a Catholic; so we are both Christians, and one way or other we must be brothers.

This last especially seemed to please him and he answered, decidedly brightening up; "Yes, yes, that is right."

I would have taken the man to be eighty; whereas he was only forty-nine. But from the constant pain and stench of his malady he could neither eat nor sleep and it seemed to me he was wishing that he were already in the grave. Honestly, he did not look as though he would live another week and I feared he might go off in despair. To inspire him with as much hope as I could I proposed to him about as follows:

"Now, Mr. N. . . . I am going to tell you something else that you can do to please God. I am inscribing your name now in our missionary work, the Seraphic Mass Association, for prayers and holy Masses always being offered for the members. You, on your part could promise the Good God in your own honest way, that if it helps, you will be earnest in finding out for yourself the difference, rather the relationship - between your denomination and the "Mother Church," which latter is, of course, none other than the Catholic." Without the least hesitation he answered at once; "Ich tu es." (I'll do it.") Then, seeing his readiness and his growing interest, I added: "And, I can assure you beforehand that inasmuch as you are earnest and honest in this matter - and prayerful at the same time -- in just so much will it become as clear to you as twice two are four, that you have your Christianity not directly from Jesus. Indirectly, yes;